

Engineering of Innovative Technologies

Workshop 1: Info & Know your customer

SDU
Startup Station
Intro



**Why do 7 out of 10 new products
introduced to the market fail?**

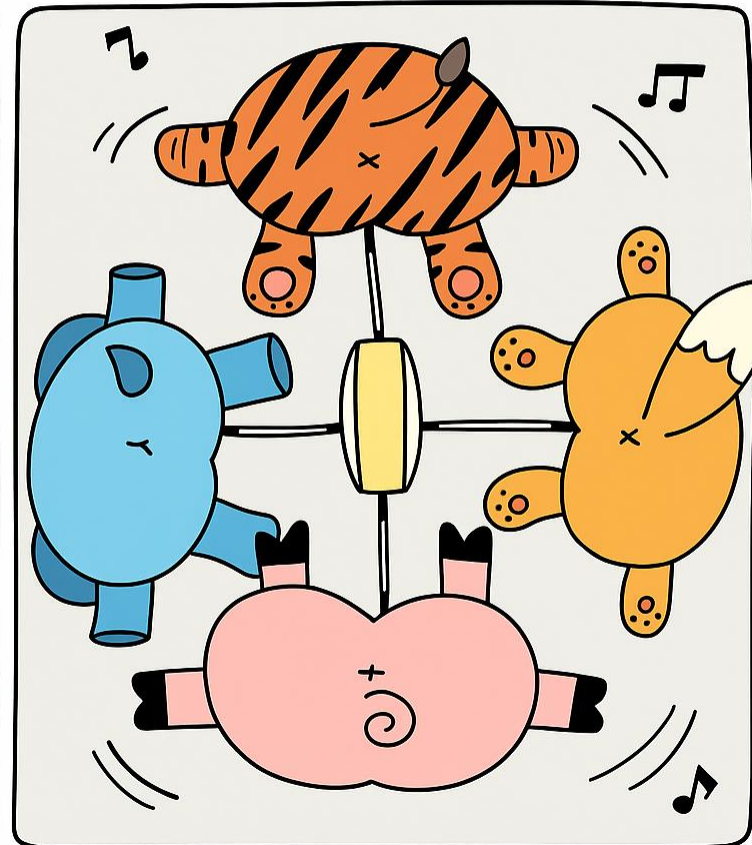
Because nobody wants it

Step into your customer's shoes

Clients



Users



Today's program



PROGRAM

SDU Startup Station

Personas

Customer profile

Lean Startup Philosophy

User research

Sign up on Entrepreneurdy

GOD FORNØJELSE!


NORDISK FILM
BIOGRAFER

SDU Startup Station



SDU Startup Station



SDU Startup Station



Sparring with a Business developer
Help to get funding and legal sparring
Startup community
Prototype facilities & creative space
Office space & meeting rooms

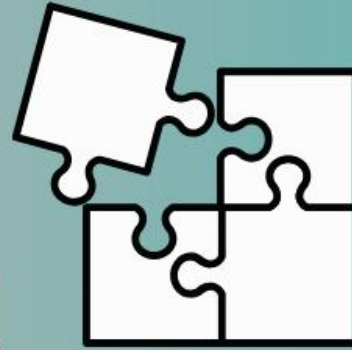
Are you curious?

Melissa Østerø Frederiksen: melf@sdu.dk

Read more: mitsdu.dk/startup

Next deadline: 21. October 2025

It's a Match



Matchmaking between students and startups:
Let's find your missing piece



SCAN ME



Persona

User or Buyer persona?

Name, age & photo

Goals & motivation

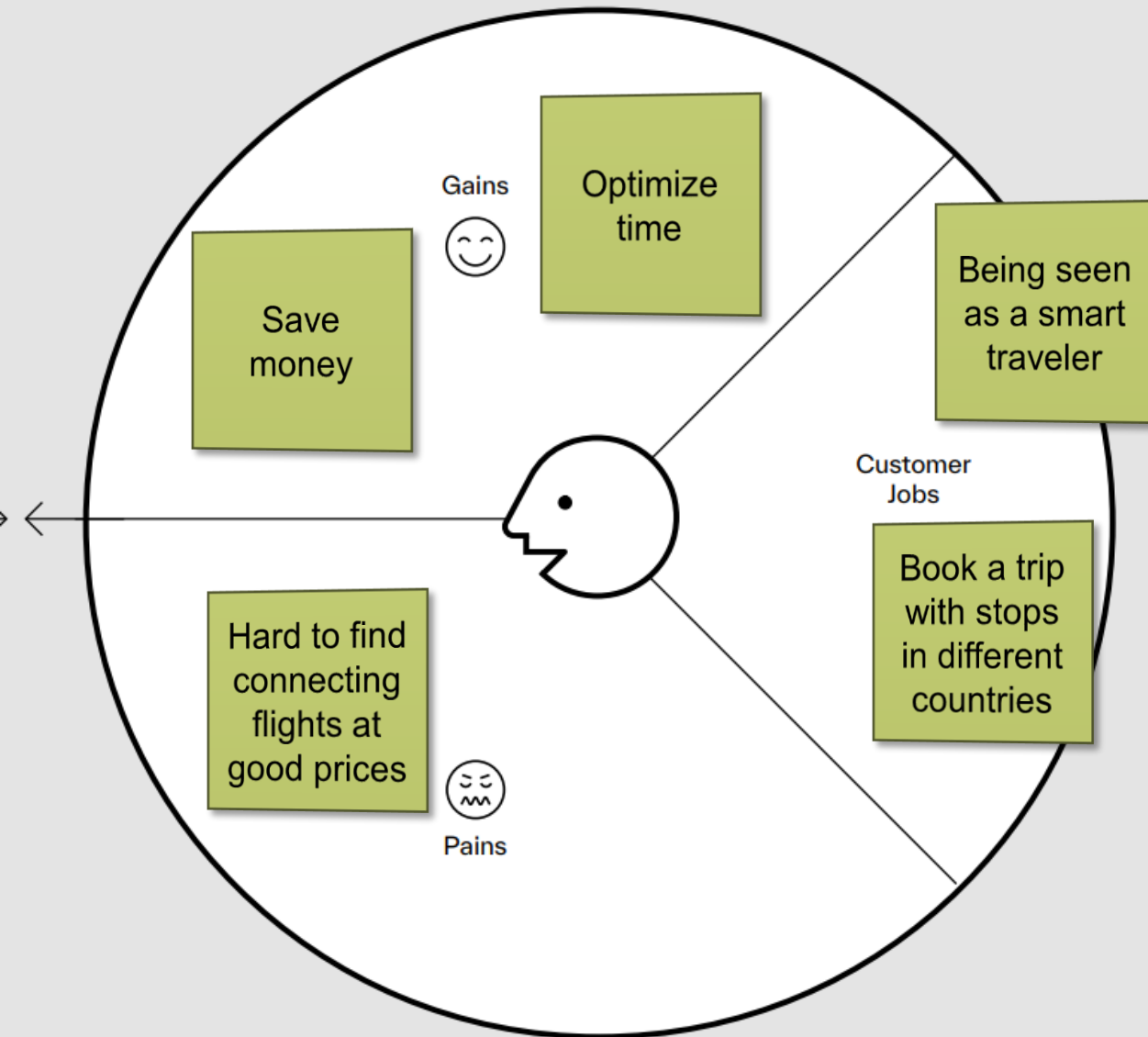
What are they trying to achieve? What motivates them to act? What values are important to them?

Story

Background, lifestyle, job, daily life (whatever that's relevant)

Frustrations

Customer Segment:



Customer Profile

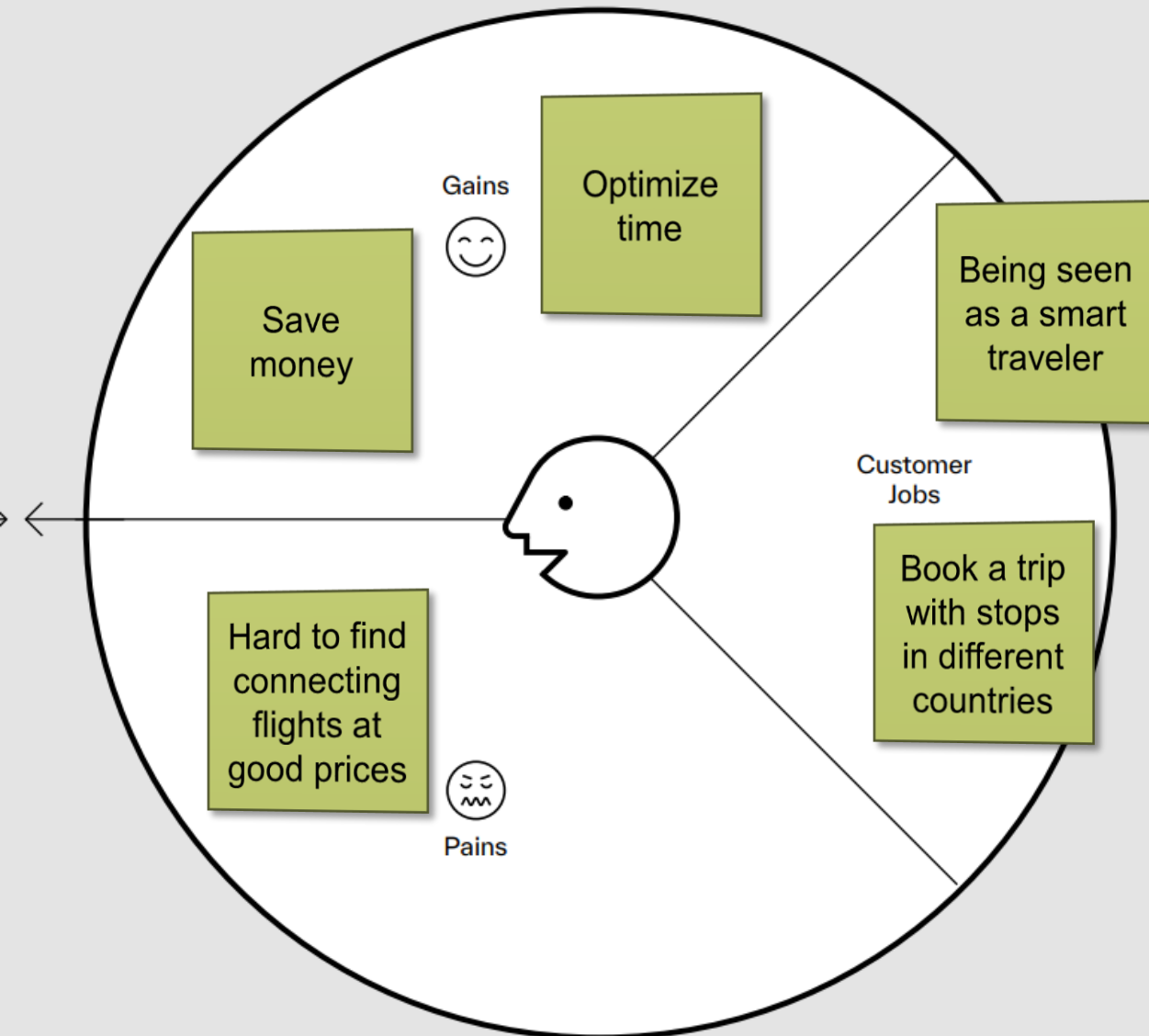
Jobs: What is the customer trying to get done?

- Functional, social, emotional

Pains: What makes the job hard, risky or frustrating?

Gains: What positive outcome would they want?

Customer Segment:



Customer Profile

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Exercise: Next

- ☐ Brainstorm LOTS of jobs, pains and gains

TIP: Think about specific moments the persona experience

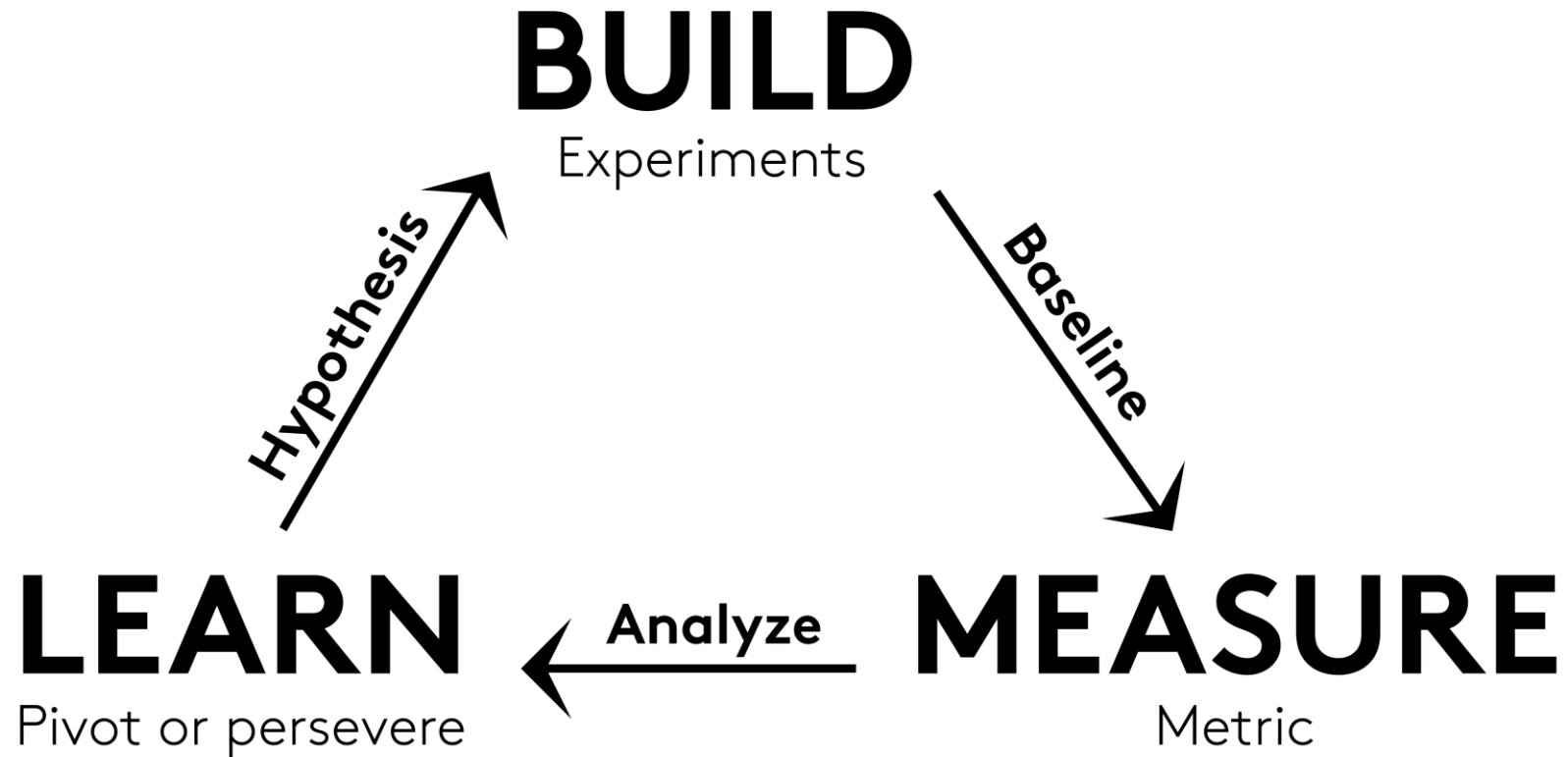
TIP TIP: Be as concrete as possible – save how much money?

- ☐ Prioritize and highlight top 3 jobs, pains and gains

Take a break until 13.37



The Lean Startup Philosophy



Pivot or persevere?

Remember:

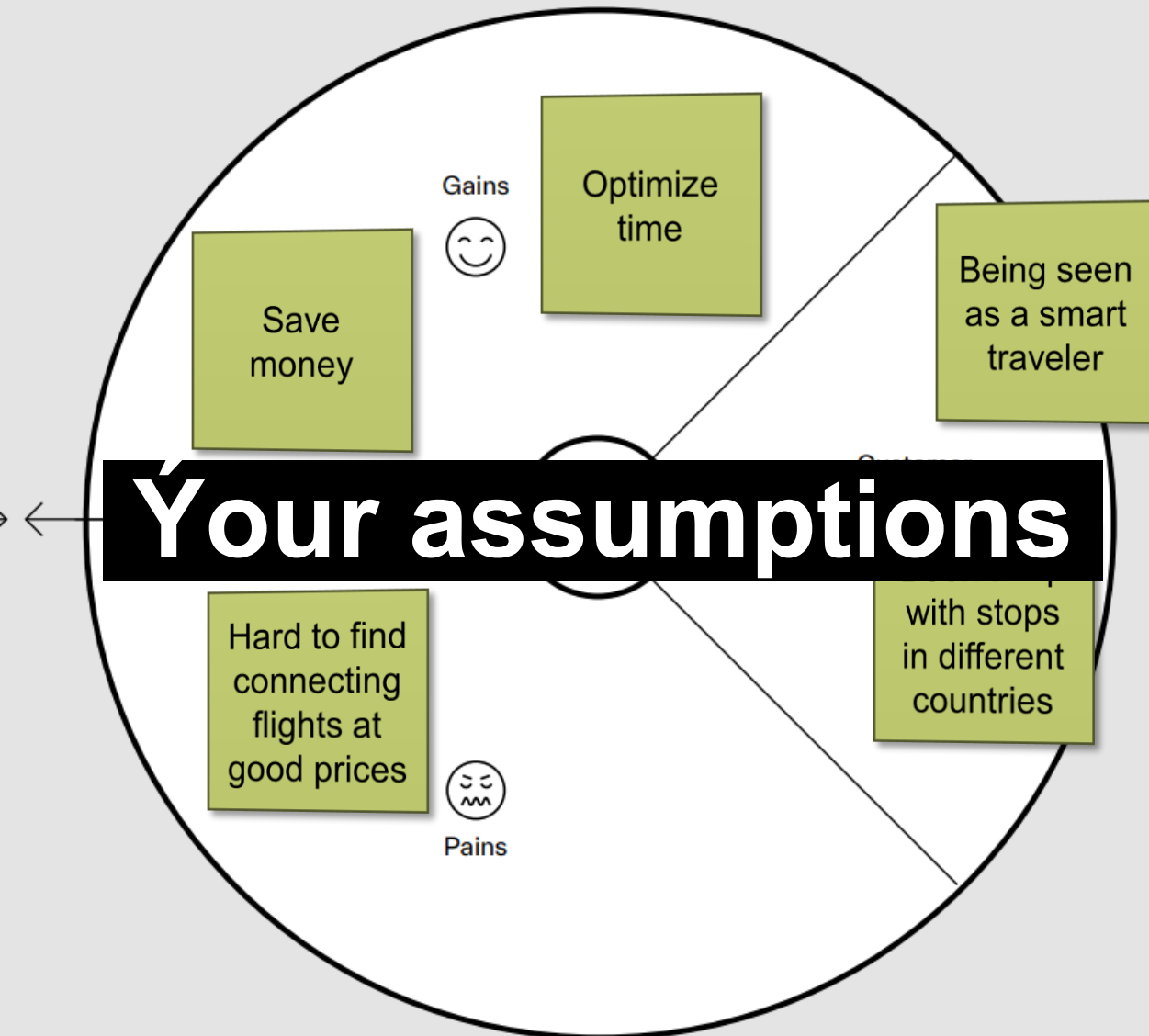
Shi[f]t happens!

You can pivot around...

1. Your customer segment
2. Your product or concept
3. Your business model
4. ... ?

Persevere?

Pivot?



Customer Profile

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Exercise: Next

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TIP: Think about specific moments the persona experience

TIP TIP: Be as concrete as possible – save how much money?

- ☐ Prioritize and highlight top 3 jobs, pains and gains

What's your hypothesis?

Hypothesis

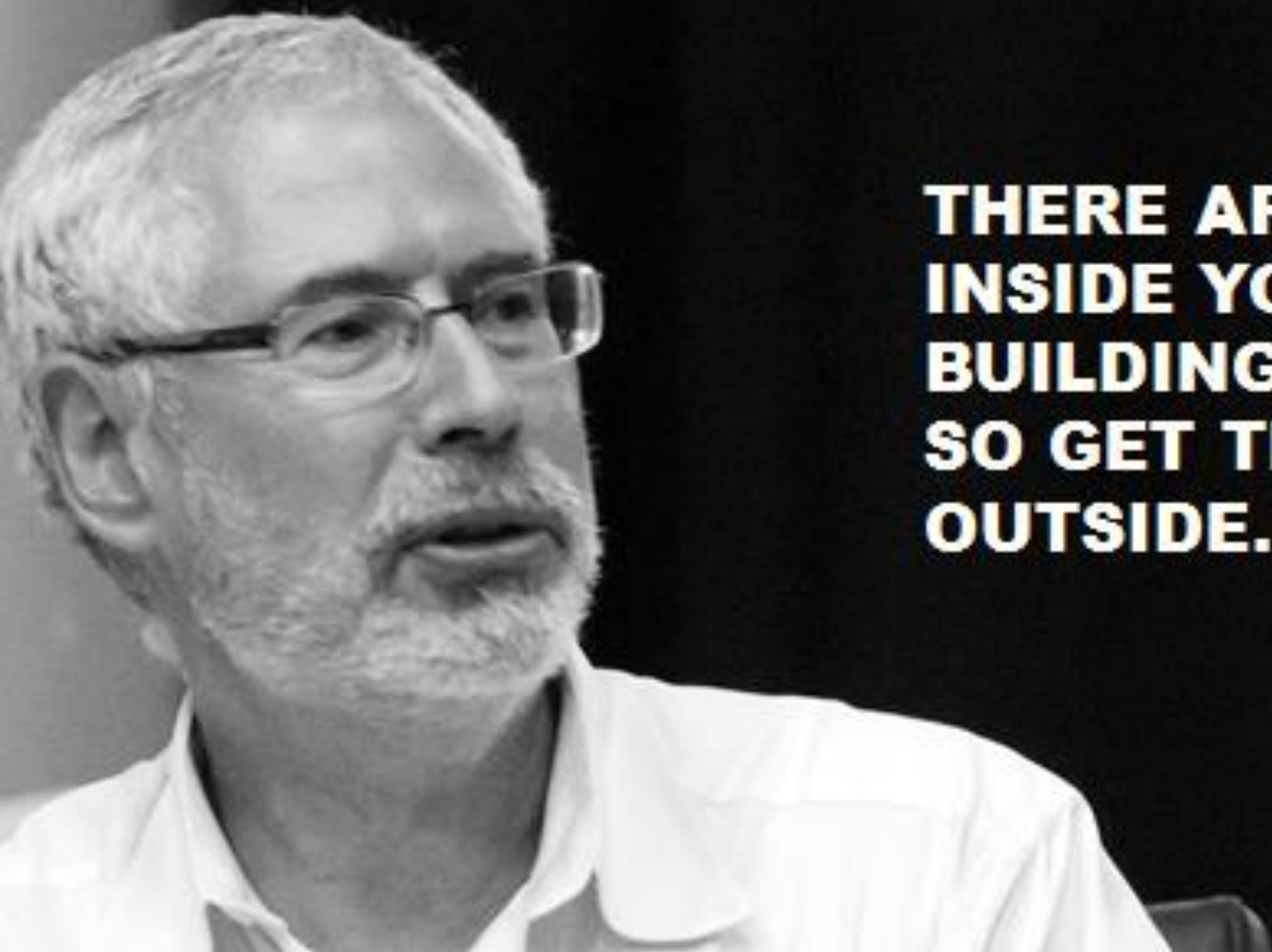
We believe that [customer segment] has a problem with [x] when [situation]

Example: We believe that first-time parents struggle to find trustworthy childcare

Measure

We will know this is true when, in interviews, [X out of Y people] confirm [specific pain]

Example: .. When at least 7 out of 10 parents mention trust as their top concern



**THERE ARE NO FACTS
INSIDE YOUR
BUILDING,
SO GET THE HECK
OUTSIDE.**

Steve Blank

Why do user research?

User research helps you:

- Validating the assumed need
- Qualifying your product (in the long run)
- Create ambassadors



Now:

**Design your own
user research process**

Overall goal with your user research

That you (and your eventual team) validates whether the need/problem is real or not...

... by interviewing at least 10 private or 3 business target customers



Ground rules for Interviewing

1. Be curious
2. Adopt a beginner's mind
3. Listen more than you talk
4. Keep asking “why”
5. The goal is insights, not selling



.. and remember!

- You don't get these insights from *surveys*
- Do **interviews** to understand the depth of the problem – and ask follow up question



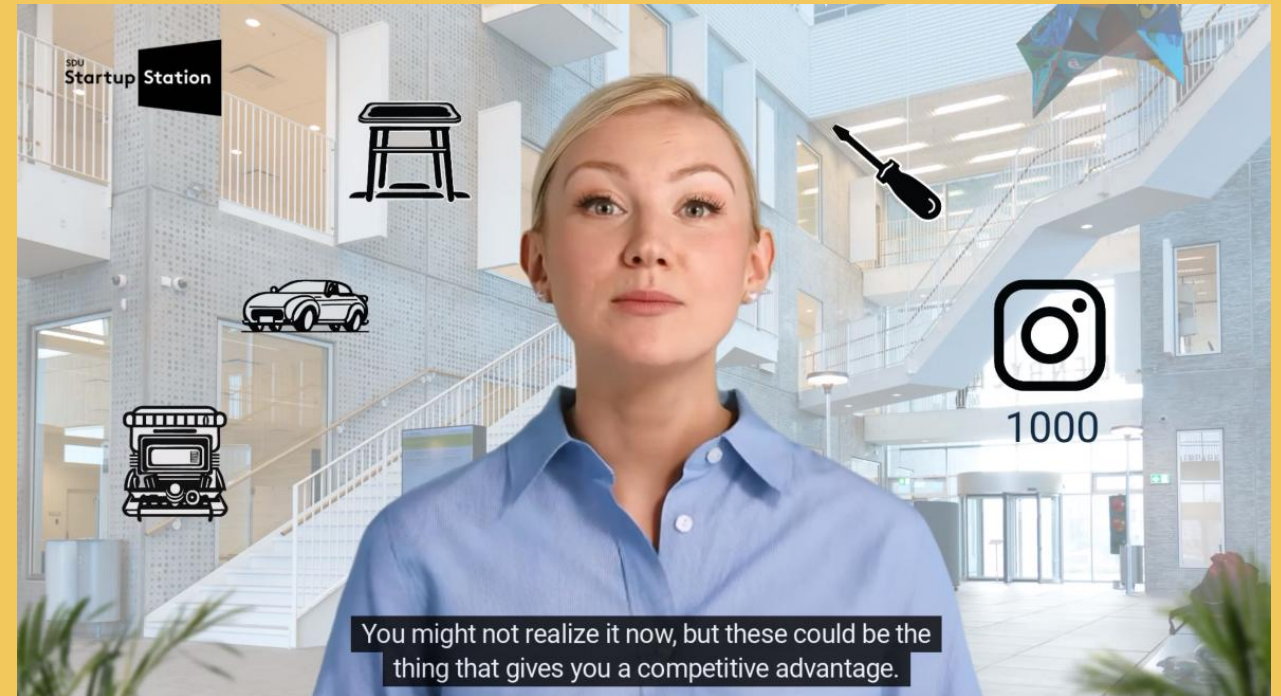
F*CK
SURVEYS
at this point

Collection of user inputs

- Can be a big task to get the overview after more user interviews.
- Group in themes and look for tendencies.
- Prioritize the larger problem areas from the users.
- If your assumptions are challenged → interview again.

Entreprenerdy

1. Sit in teams, where one signs up
2. Watch the videos with your team
3. Invite your teammembers



sdu.entreprenerdy.com/programs/eitodense

What are your takeaways?



What's
next?



Now you have

- ✓ Defined a **persona** representing your target customer
- ✓ A mapped **customer profile** (with jobs, pains and gains)
- ✓ An understanding of the **Lean startup mindset** (test, test... test)
- ✓ A **research plan** with interview questions to test assumptions

Next

- ❑ Test your assumptions by interviewing potential customers



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